1945 Bush wrote an article, describing a device (called *memex*), the prototype of the modern hypertext systems.

Bush became vice-president and dean of engineering at MIT from 1932 until 1938. In 1938 he accepted a prestigious appointment as President of the Carnegie Institution of Washington. The institution spent $1.5 million annually on research. The presidency of the institution came with a lot of prestige. The president influenced the direction of research in the U.S. and informally advised the government on scientific matters.

In 1940 Bush was appointed Chairman of the President's *National Defense Research Committee*, and in 1941 Director of the *Office of Scientific Research and Development*. These two appointments made Bush a central figure in the development of nuclear fission and the *Manhattan Project* (the atomic bomb).

In 1944 President Roosevelt asks Bush for recommendations on the application of "lessons learned" from WWII to civilian, peace-time activities. Bush submits the article Science, the Endless Frontier in response to Roosevelt›s request. He outlined the importance of continued support for research. He called for a *National Research Foundation* that «should develop and promote a national policy for scientific research and scientific education, should support basic research in nonprofit organizations, should develop scientific talent in American youth by means of scholarships and fellowships, and should by contract and otherwise support long-range research on military matters". It was this proposal which set off events leading to the development of the National Science Foundation in 1950.

During the next decades Bush was appointed a Chairman or Director of many institutions of critical importance for USA: in 1946—Chairman of the Joint Research and Development Board of the War and Navy Departments; in 1947—Chairman of the Development Board of National Military Establishment; in 1947—director of AT&T; in 1957—Chairman of the MIT Corporation, from 1957 to 1962 he was chairman of the large pharmaceutical corporation Merck & Co., etc.

Vannevar Bush died from pneumonia after suffering a stroke on June 28, 1974, in Belmont, Massachusetts.